Energy

GLOBAL MONTHLY MARKET INSIGHT

November 2026

IN THIS REPORT

2-4 Monthly Price Movements Crude oil and natural gas prices rose throughout October, driven by ongoing supply disruption caused by attacks on tankers in the Strait of Hormuz.

5-6 Supply and Demand Natural gas storage levels in Europe remain markedly lower YOY, adding to supply fears ahead of the winter.

7-8 Other Price Drivers Inflation accelerated in the US, the Eurozone, and China throughout September due to elevated energy prices.

Key Takeaways

- **Crude oil** prices continued to increase throughout October, driven upwards by ongoing disruption to supply caused by the increased frequency of attacks on tankers in the Strait of Hormuz. In the US ending stocks dwindled due to high utilization and increased export demand.
- **Natural gas** prices in Europe rose markedly throughout the month due to market players' fears over supply and the level of natural gas in storage, especially ahead of winter. In the US, climbed slightly throughout October although the market remained steady. Players noted increased export demand from Europe and Asia.
- **Electricity prices** increased in Europe, reflecting rising natural gas prices as well as lower solar output. In the US, electricity prices continued to decline throughout the month in line with a seasonal softening of the market.

Product	Expana Series	October Price	MOM%	YOY%
Crude Oil Brent ICE EU	BCRD	$107.89 /barrel	+5.8%	+68.7%
Natural Gas TTF NL	NGNL	€85.92/ MWh	+14.0%	+168.9%
Natural Gas NYMEX US	NGAS	$3.01/ 10Therm	+1.9%	-10.6%
Electricity Index Europe	EFA1	€178.97/ MWh	+12.3%	+114.5%
Electricity Ind US	LY32	USc 8.86/ KWh	-7.5%	+2.4%

Market Sentiment



- Market sentiments in energy remain 'mildly firm', unchanged from the previous month. Supply disruption is expected by market participants to continue, and sources see no immediate end to the conflict in the Middle East.
- Although the lower supply of crude oil and natural gas remains a key driver, players anticipate increased demand as the cooler winter months arrive. Natural gas storage levels in Europe remain a chief concern for market participants because they are markedly lower YOY.

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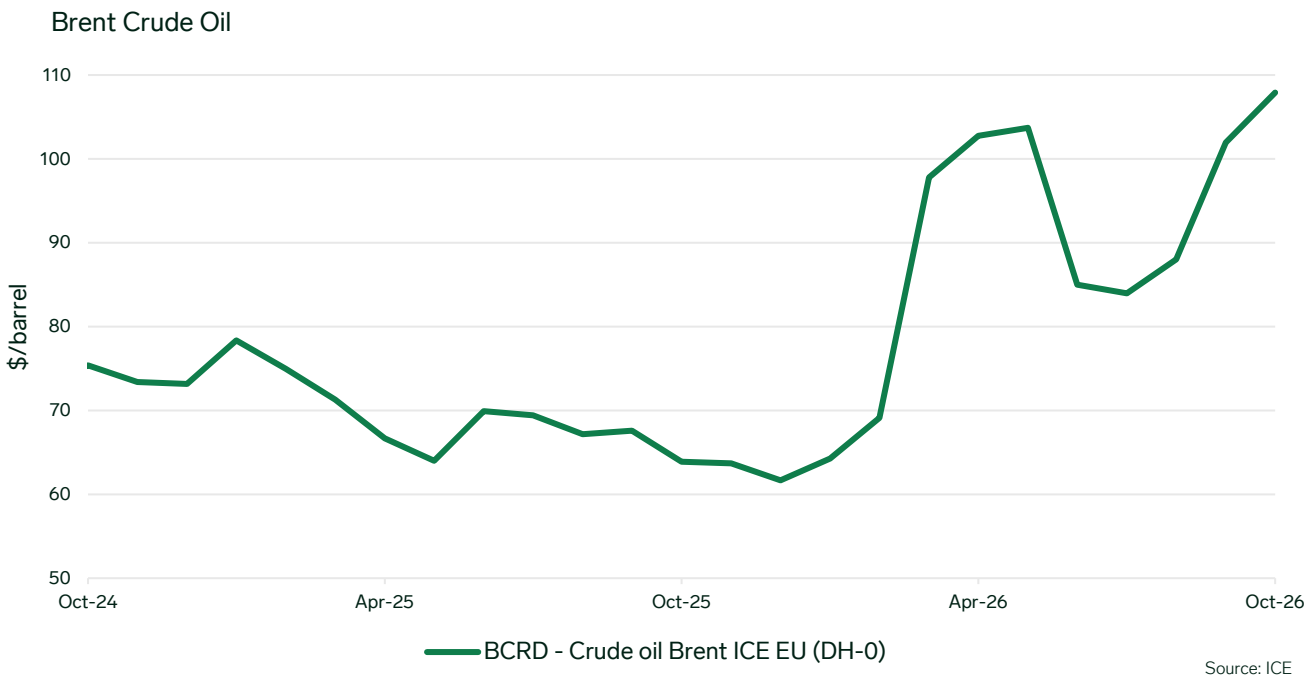
Monthly Price Movements & Market Sentiment

Crude Oil

November 2026

Monthly Price Movements

The increased frequency of attacks on commercial shipping resulting in higher MOM crude oil prices.



- Crude oil prices rose again in October, extending the upward trend that began in July 2026, though the MOM gain was smaller than in September.
- Market players remained concerned about Gulf supply as attacks on commercial shipping became more frequent throughout the month. Volumes exiting via the Strait of Hormuz stayed low, supporting prices.

Market Sentiment



- Market sentiment within the crude oil market remains 'mildly firm', unchanged from the previous month. Market players expect attacks on commercial shipping to continue throughout November, unless a deal to end the Middle East conflict is agreed.
- Crude oil supply will remain a central concern, say market participants, with pipelines in Saudi Arabia and the UAE unable to compensate for ongoing Strait of Hormuz disruption.
- Buyers are increasingly turning to the US-origin crude, with US ending stocks continuing to dwindle due to high refinery utilization and climbing exports.

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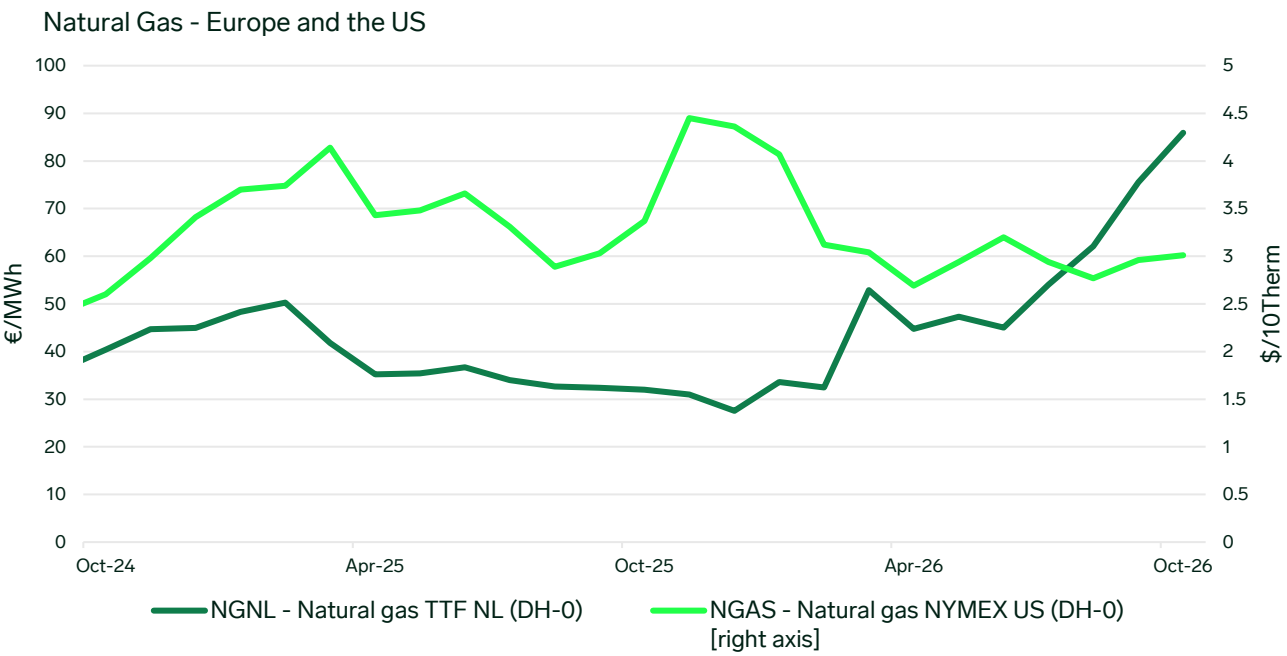
Monthly Price Movements & Market Sentiment

Natural Gas

November 2026

Monthly Price Movements

Prices rose throughout the month, with players remaining worried about supply in Europe.



- In Europe, natural gas prices continued to rise markedly throughout October, extending the upward trend that has been evident for most of 2026. Players expressed major concerns due to disrupted imports from Gulf states, such as Qatar, and the increased frequency of attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz, which deterred many carriers from attempting to traverse the Strait throughout October. Storage levels in the EU remain notably lower YOY.
- In the US, prices increased slightly due to greater volumes moving to exports, against the backdrop of elevated demand from EU and Asian states.

Market Sentiment – Europe



- Sentiment remains 'mildly firm' due to ongoing worries about import supply in the region. Players do not foresee any change in this trend, and the increased winter heating use by businesses and consumers anticipated by market sources means players expect higher demand.
- Storage levels remain lower YOY, adding to concerns about available supply ahead of the winter.

Market Sentiment – US



- Sentiment within the US natural gas market remains 'steady', unchanged from the previous month. Market players anticipate continued increased exports to Europe and Asia due to supply issues in those regions.

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Monthly Price Movements & Market Sentiment

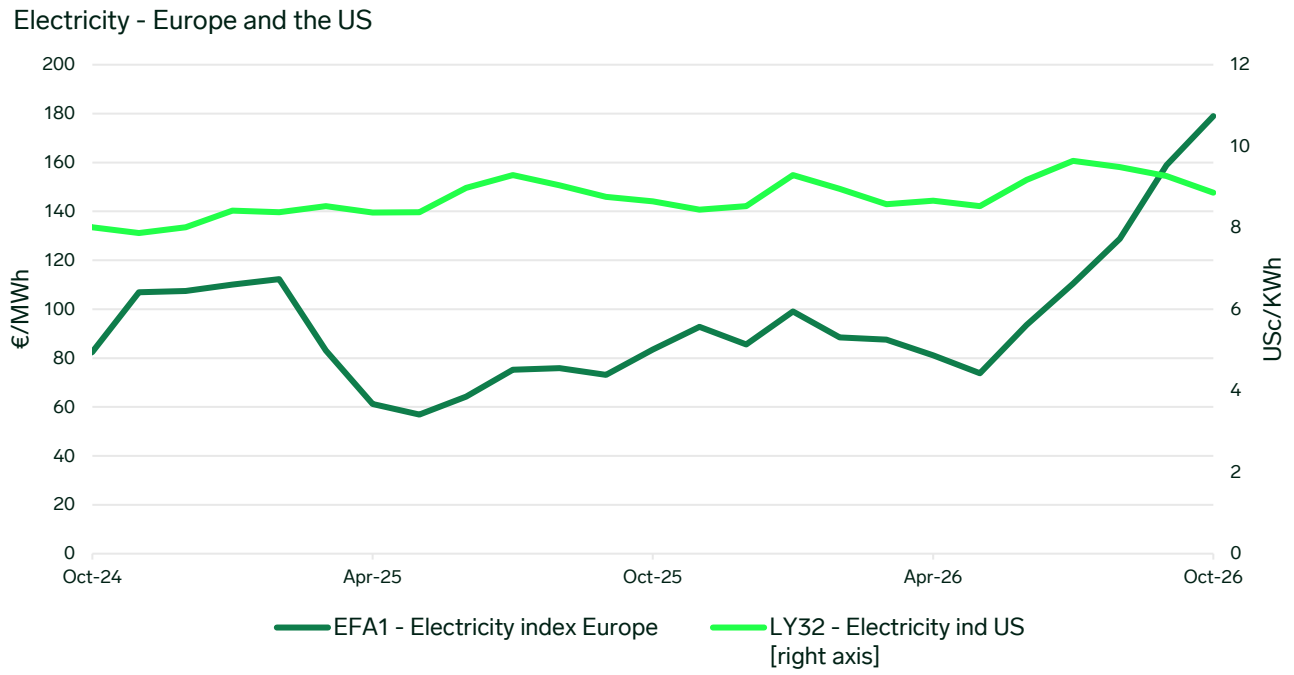
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Electricity

November 2026

Monthly Price Movements

Electricity prices in Europe moved significantly higher throughout the month following increased natural gas prices.



Source: Expana, EIA

- In Europe, the electricity index continued a sustained upward trend since May, as natural gas remains a significant component supporting prices, and as solar generation decreases with fewer daylight hours.
- In the US, prices fell slightly, extending the trend in place since July 2026, in line with seasonally softer prices.

Market Sentiment – Europe



- Sources' sentiment remains 'mildly firm' on the back of rising natural gas prices, and expectations of higher October demand.
- Looking ahead at November, over the last decade, European prices [EFA1] been affected by gas prices, with most up and down movements following the gas price curve, data shows. EU gas storage stood at around 75% of capacity, lowest since at least 2009, according to sources. Lower solar generation hours and temperatures have also tended to offer support to power prices in November in the past.

Market Sentiment – US



- Sentiment in the US remained 'steady' with prices continuing to fall in line with a seasonal drop in demand.
- Although the slight increase in natural gas prices was not passed through into electricity prices, players still believe this dynamic could eventually apply upward pressure on US electricity prices.

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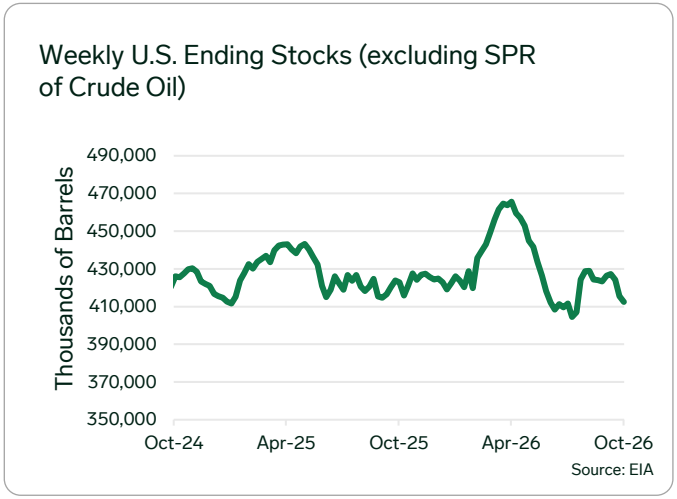
US Weekly Ending Stocks

- As of October 16 (latest data), US crude oil weekly ending stocks fell 3.3% MOM, representing a 3.2% YOY decrease, declining to 412.5 million barrels. Utilization at refineries remains elevated compared to year-ago levels, while exports were reportedly higher MOM due to more US barrel being moved into export markets, attributable to dwindling supply from the Middle East.
- According to the October Short-Term Energy Outlook from the EIA, US crude oil production is forecast to reach 13.9 mb/d in 2026 (up 100 kb/d compared to September's forecast) and 14.3 mb/d in 2027 (unchanged compared to September's forecast). Overall, though, the EIA's production forecasts continue to increase for 2026 and 2027.

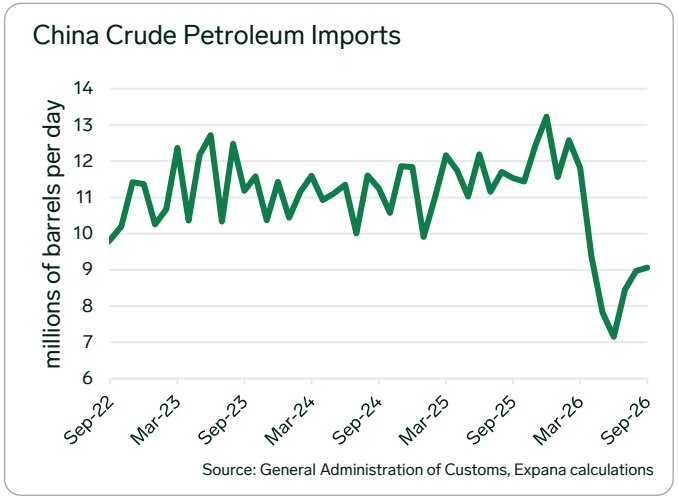
China Imports

- China, the world's largest crude oil importer, saw its crude oil imports average 9.06 mb/d in September (latest data, provisional), up 1.0% from 8.97 mb/d in August, falling 21.5% YOY, according to data from the General Administration of Customs of China and Expana calculations. Players in China are attempting to restock where possible but are competing with buyers in other parts of the world for a limited barrel pool, resulting in prices being paid by Chinese players exceeding recent highs.

Ending stocks continue to decline due to high utilization and increased export demand.



Imports moved up slightly MOM according to the latest data, as players restock.



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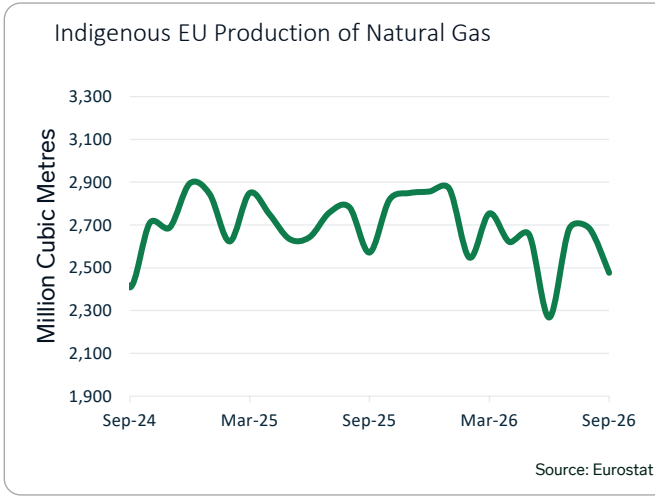
Europe

- In September (latest data, provisional), the total indigenous natural gas production in the EU was down 7.8% MOM, at 2,476 million cubic meters, representing a 3.7% YOY decrease.
- Combined with declining imports and lower YOY storage levels, falling indigenous production is causing major worry among market players ahead of the winter, when heating demand is usually higher than in the autumn.

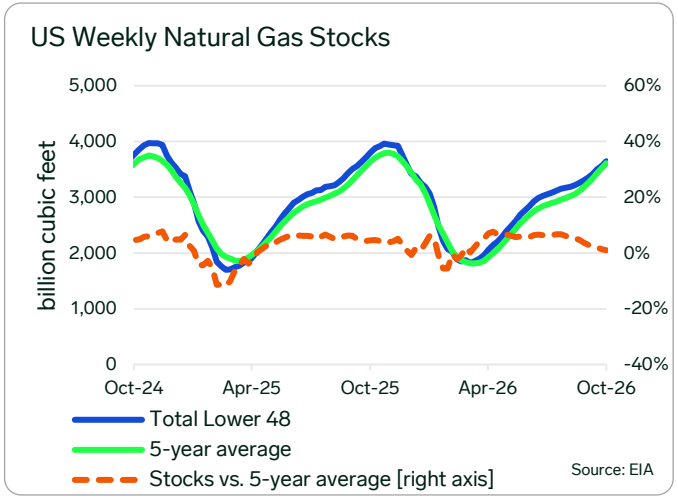
US

- According to the EIA, working gas in storage in the lower 48 states of the US was 3,644 billion cubic feet as of October 16 (latest data). The figure is 1.0% above the five-year average, representing a 4.3% YOY decrease.

Players are worried about tightening supply ahead of the winter.



Natural gas stocks remain slightly above the five-year average.



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Europe

•According to the latest data, overall EU electricity generation fell to 191.8TWh in September, from 198.1TWh in August, although it was higher compared to September 2025. Demand also edged down from August.

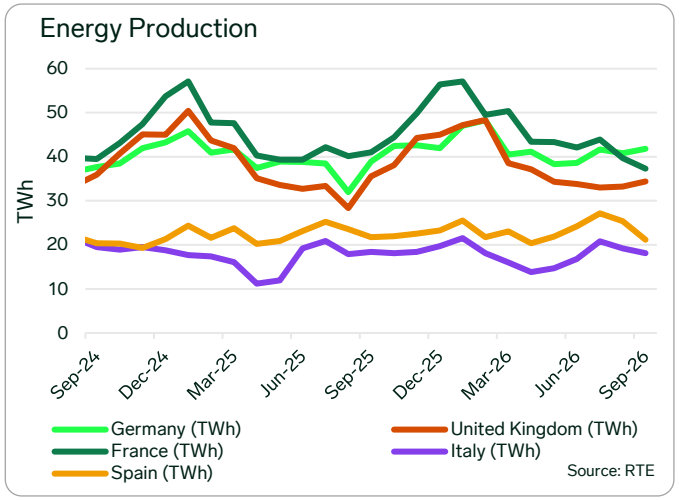
•Out the five largest markets, production fell the most in Spain, by 17%, but generation also fell by around 6% in Italy and France. The fall was driven by lower solar output in all major markets. Germany and the UK rose MOM, by 3% to 41.8TWh and by 4% to 37.3TWh, respectively.

•Coal-fired output rose across the EU, and specially in Germany, both YOY and MOM, driven by high natural gas prices, coal was more price-competitive than usual. This is the second consecutive month with higher YOY coal-fired output.

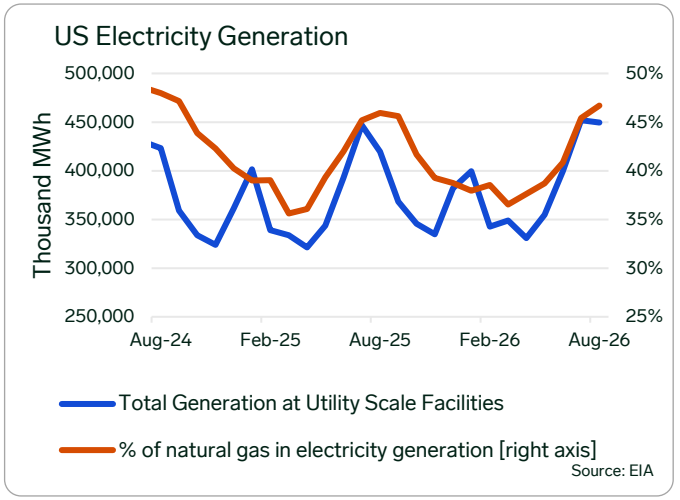
US

- According to the EIA, in the US, total electricity generation at utility-scale facilities reached 449,406k MWh in August (latest available data), down 0.6% MOM, representing a 7.1% YOY increase.
- Natural gas represented 47% of the total generation, up from 45% in the previous month.
- According to market sources, seasonality was behind the slide MOM dip, owing to cooler weather. Furthermore, natural gas cheapened in comparison to coal, resulting in natural gas increasing as a share of electricity generation throughout August.

Overall electricity generation fell across Europe's largest markets in September.



Electricity generation remains notably higher YOY, dipping slightly MOM.



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Other Price Drivers

Macroeconomic and Logistics

Expana

November 2026

Inflation

- In the US, annualized headline inflation accelerated to 3.7% in September, up from 3.4% in August. Energy inflation again propelled the headline figure, registering 20.4% YOY. In the Eurozone, headline inflation was 3.8% YOY in September, accelerating from 3.2% YOY in August. In China, annualized headline inflation accelerated to 0.9% in September, up from 0.8% in August. Energy inflation rose 14.9% YOY, resulting in accelerating transport and telecommunication inflation, at 4.3% YOY.

USDX and Interest Rates

- The Expana USDX rose 1.2% MOM in October, settling at 102.12. The upward movement was chiefly driven by the continued safe-haven demand from investors due to the ongoing Middle East conflict and the intensification of attacks on commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. Furthermore, there is a general expectation among market participants that the US Federal Reserve will hike interest rates by another 25 basis points before the end of 2026.

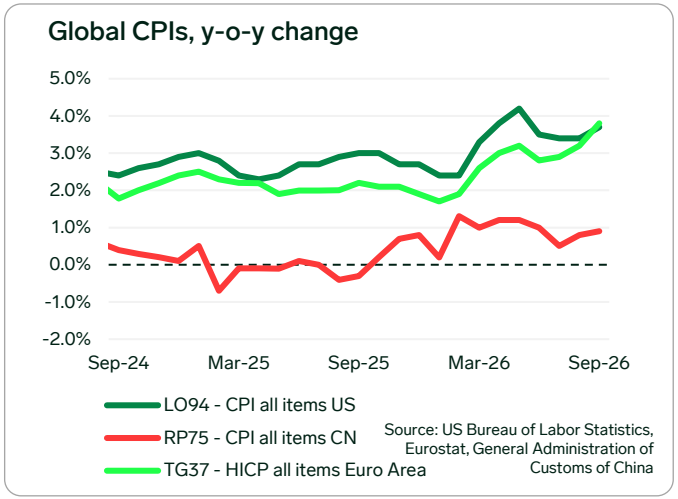
Asia Natural Gas Prices

- Asian LNG prices rose 11.8% MOM and 156.6% YOY in October to $28.52/10Therm. Shipments through the Strait of Hormuz continued to fall, resulting in increased competition for imports by players in Europe and Asia.

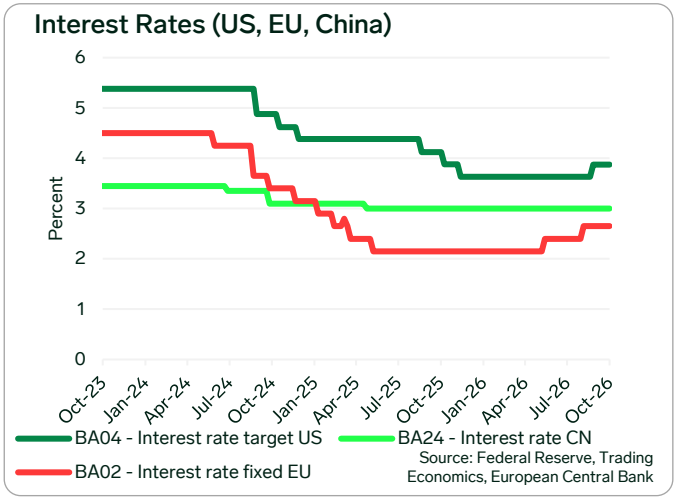
Tanker Indices

- The dirty tanker index rose 74.8% MOM and 515.2% YOY in October, while the clean tanker index rose 38.7% MOM and 343.1% YOY. The increased frequency of attacks on commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz resulted in higher risk premiums.

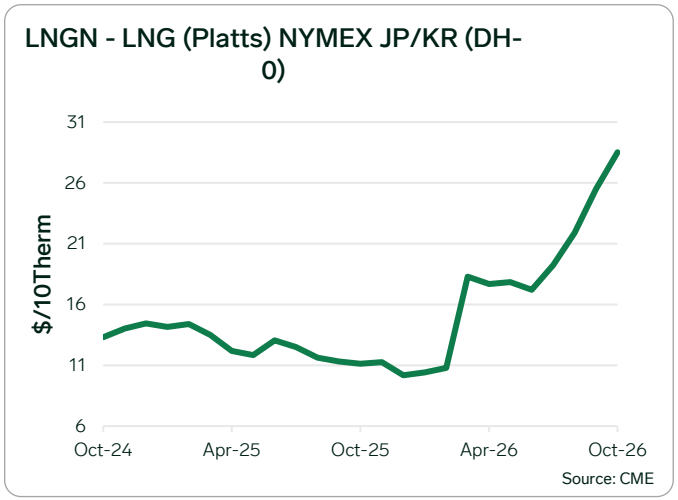
Inflation continued to accelerate throughout September, propelled by elevated energy prices.



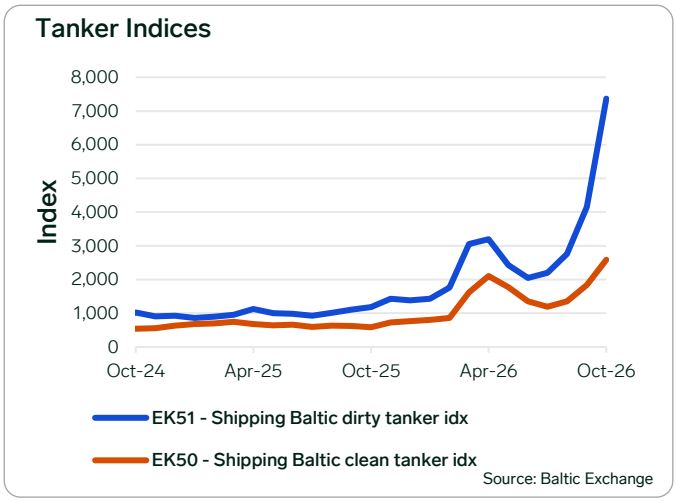
Market players expect another 25 basis point interest rate hike before year-end in the US and in the EU.



Competition for natural gas remains elevated due to disruption in the Middle East.



The increased frequency of attacks on Middle East commercial shipping fueled the uptrend.



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Abbreviations and Acronyms

BCFD	Billion Cubic Feet per Day
BCM	Billion cubic metres
EIA	Energy Information Administration
EUR	Euro
USD	US Dollar
MMcf	One Million Cubic Feet
MWh	Megawatt Hour
GW	Gigawatts
MW	Megawatts
LNG	Liquified Natural Gas
GWh/d	Gigawatts Hours per Day
TWh	Tera-watt Hour
SPR	Strategic Petroleum Reserve
Winter	October - March

Date of next publication: The report is published on the last business day of the month; therefore, the next date of publication will be Monday, November 30.



Market Sentiment Definitions:

Firm — Demand exceeds supply, prices moving higher.
Steady — Supplies and demand generally in good balance-prices unchanged.
Weak — Supplies plentiful for demand and prices moving lower.

Methodology, Feedback & Forward-Looking Statements:

Expana is committed to ensuring all published Expana Benchmark Prices are representative of market value, and in line with Expana's transparency principles, we encourage industry participants to reach out to the PRA Team. Any feedback and comments related to this document and the prices contained within are welcomed and should be directed to PRA@expanamarkets.com.

For details on the methodology used to assess the Expana Benchmark Prices, visit this link.

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